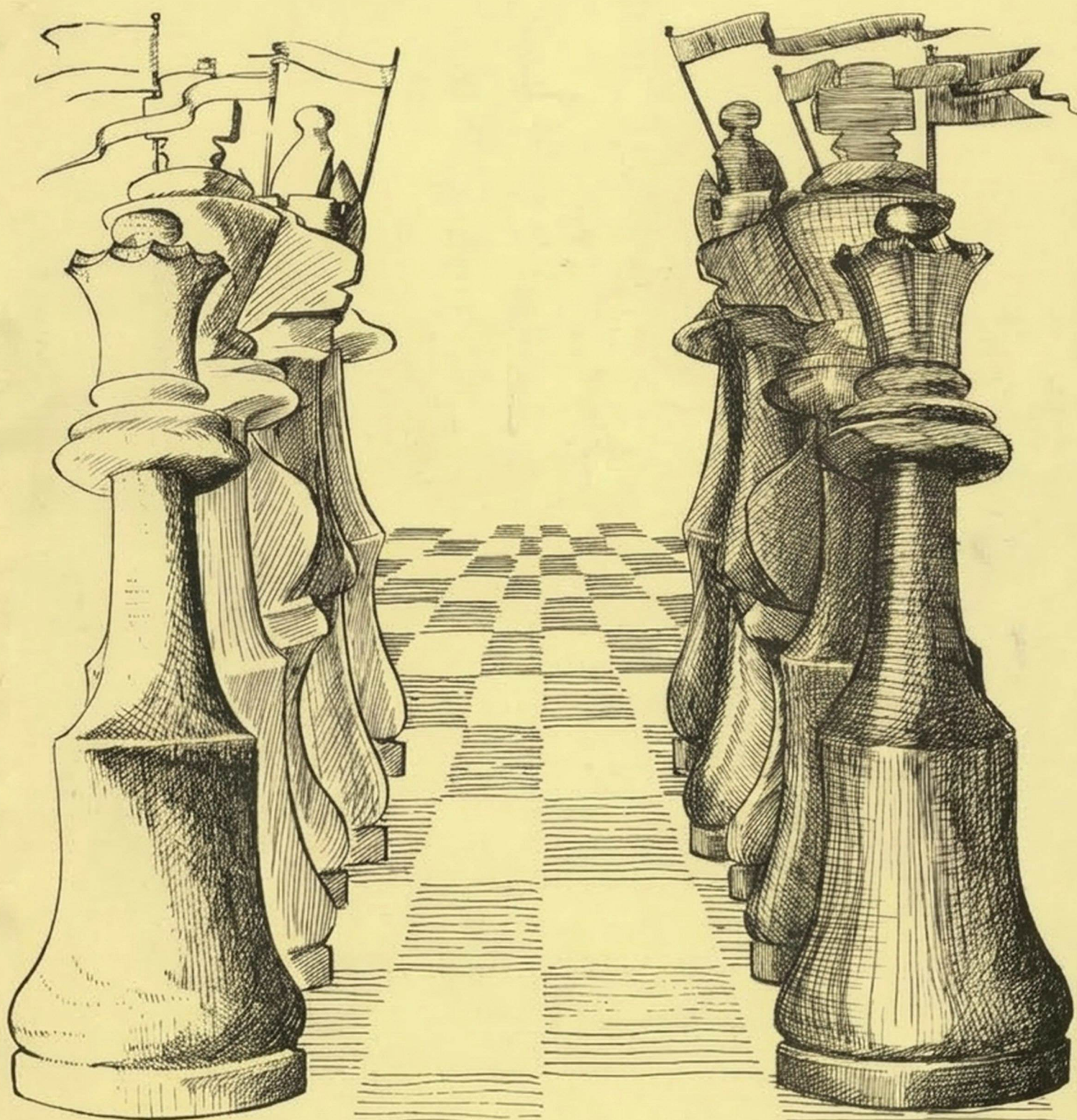


POPULAR CHESS

No. 6



Spring begins with the possible collapse of CHESS EXPRESS after 8 issues. I suppose it was remarkably brainless to haul in all these International Grandmasters and offer them vast sums of money on the offchance of a good circulation. Who did the costing on the venture, especially after the experience of the 1979 magazine "International Chess"? (That lasted 2½ issues). Ah well. CHESS and BCM can breathe again and Popular Chess will continue to potter along with its 300 subscribers....

Meanwhile, thanks to COMPETENCE, I have a review Mephisto III machine, which gets the thumbs up sign. In a match against the Novag Constellation, generally reckoned machine of the year, Mephisto was beaten 4-2. However, the games were up and down affairs without any great superiority by one machine over the other.

Finally, followers of the CHESS TRAINING scheme will be delighted to know that the SILVER level is out. This scheme is unique in that it trains a beginner up to club level, thus bridging a tremendous gap in chess teaching.

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The GOLD has yet to be written, but likely topics are the king side attack, development of an opening repertoire, rook and pawn endings, advanced tactics and positional play in the middle game.

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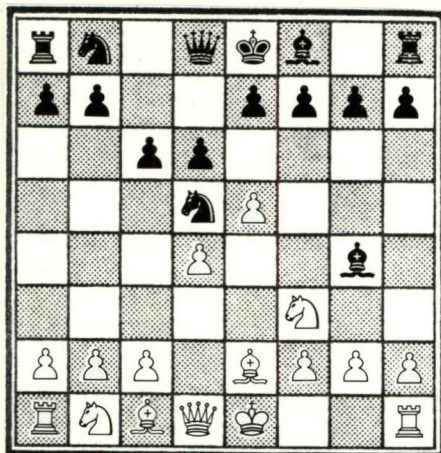
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OVER THE HILL

At present I am graded 162. The highest I have been graded was 180 (1971). I play in the Birmingham League (Div. 1), the odd county match and local congresses. Most weekend I play 5 minute games with a few friends.

When I was younger I was influenced by the attacking players such as Morphy, Alekhine, Spielmann etc and tried to copy their combinational style (one of my better efforts from about 1960 ran:

- 1 e4 Nf6
- 2 e5 Nd5
- 3 d4 d6
- 4 Nf3 Bg4
- 5 Be2 c6



(I knew there was a line that went 6 c4 and 7 Qb3 but had forgotten the analysis, so intended to play 6 c4 followed by 7 Nbd2 which some Russian analyst had recommended. Unfortunately, I played Nbd2 first!)

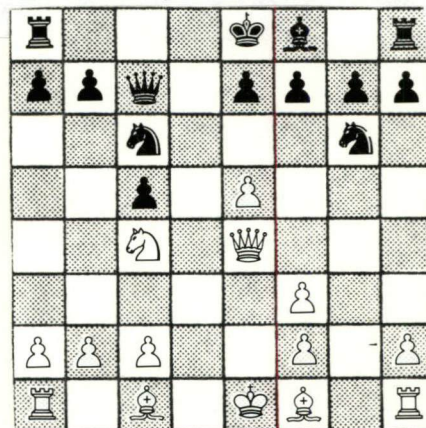
- 6 Nbd2 Nf4!

(Hitting my bishop and knightspawn, after recovering a bit, I played

- 7 Bf1 de
- 8 de Qc7
- 9 Nc4 Ng6
- 10 Qd4 Bxf3
- 11 gf

(Black should now play something like e6, Bc5 + 0-0-0 but instead played the plausible c5

- 12 Qe4 Nc6

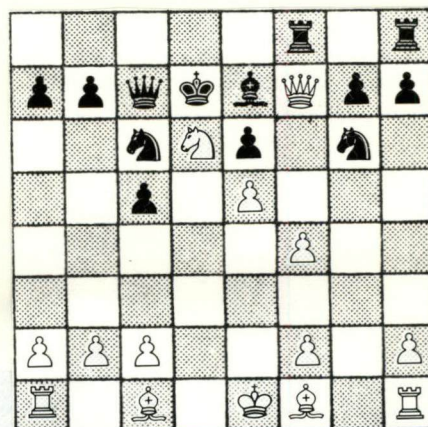


- 13 Nd6+! Kd7

(I observed that black was somewhat disconcerted by my last and pressed on with

- 14 Qf5+ e6
- 15 Qxf7+ Be7
- 16 f4 Raf8

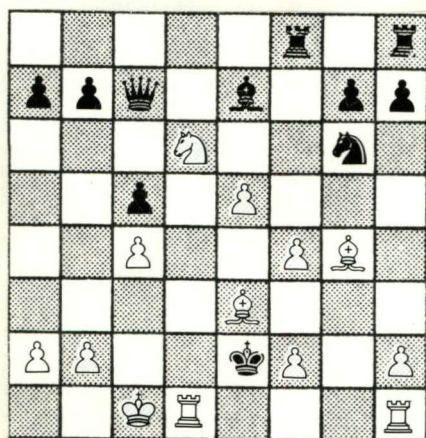
(I had expected this but was more worried by 16 Ngxe5
17 fe5 Nxe5 18 Qxg7 Qxd6 now I was able to 'sacrifice' the queen and pull the black king all the way down the board).



- 17 Qxe6+! Kxe6?

Played almost at once (shellshock?)
Now the black king's fate is sealed.

18 Bh3+ Kd5
 19 c4+ Kd4
 20 Be3+ Kd3
 21 0-0-0+ Ke2
 22 Bg4 mate



(Of course, I was pleased with the finish but would have been even more so had I seen the less efficient but more beautiful

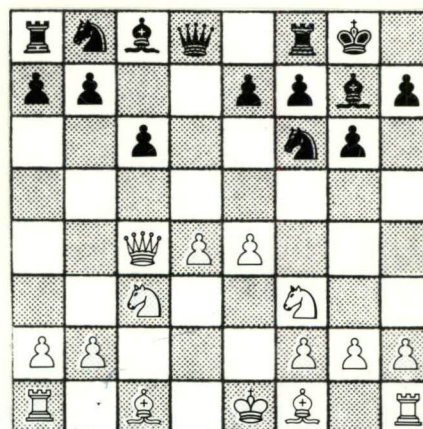
21 Rad1+ Kc2
 22 Rd2+ Kb1
 23 B3!! (A quiet move, allowing the rare finish 24 0-0 mate against any black reply)

I seemed unable to get away from this flashy style of play for ages. Indeed it became rather embarrassing at times. Local journalists would rush up to me in the club and beg me for some short, snappy game for their columns. Impassively I would gaze upon them and offer my last half dozen games for their perusal, and off they would rush, gratified but uncomprehending into the night. The strong Leicester player L.A. Edwards told me an amusing tale a couple of years ago. It was the first time we had met and he won very easily. This, he said, gave him much satisfaction since for years whenever he achieved some victory or other in Leicester circles someone or other was to remark 'AH! But you should have been here when G. Hill was in the club'. Whatever he did, apparently, was never, according to some people, as good as the great games between Taberkiernik-Hill or Hill-Scholes.

Nowadays, I am trying to develop some insight into the more strategical aspects of the game. I find some of the concepts just as exciting as playing combinations.

At present I am working through Bronstein's 1953 Tournament Book and am learning quite a lot I think. And I have borrowed, from the library, Pachman's 'Modern Chess Strategy' which is quite useful. Euwe's ' Middlegame ' is good too. But I think there should be more books than there are that are advanced and comprehensive on this aspect of the game, taking in all the discoveries and refinements from, say, 1950. After the second world war, the Russians seemed to have developed exciting new ideas in a whole range of openings - particularly in the King's Indian, Grünfeld and Sicilian. I remember a game of Boleslavsky which went

1 d4 Nf6
 2 c4 g6
 3 Nc3 d5
 4 Nf3 Bg7
 5 Qb3 dc
 6 Qxc4 0-0
 7 e4 c6



8 Be2 b5!
 9 Qb3 Qa5
 10 Bd2 b4
 11 Nd1 Nxe4
 12 Bxb4

Black has smashed white's pawn centre and will achieve active piece co-ordination, posting his rook on B8 (after Na6) and his c8 bishop on d5. The pawn at c6, which in Tarrash's day would have been seen as weak, backward, isolated and on an open file can be protected simply by Be6-d5.

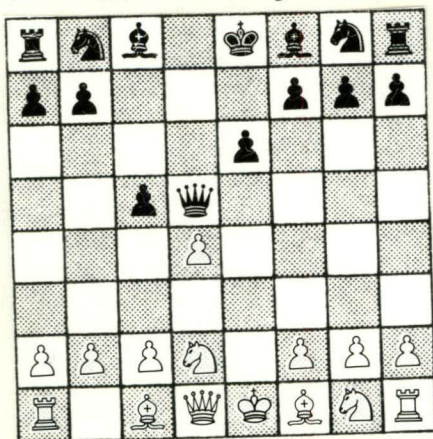
Then there were those lovely, flowing achievements of Bronstein in the King's Indian (Zita-Bronstein, for example) with the 'weak' black d6 pawn laughing at white down the open d file. Very pleasing too are the new defences of the British players such as the English Defence and the Birmingham (St. George) Defence, particularly when played by Miles.

To end, here are some ideas in the French Defence.

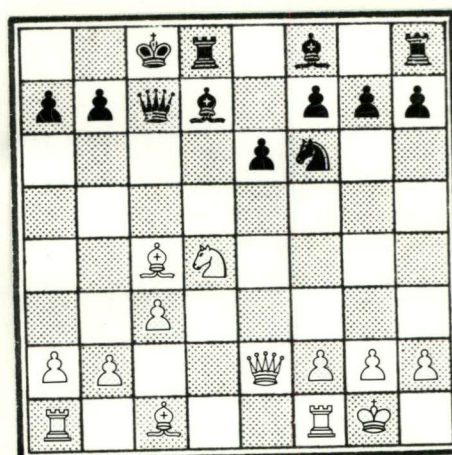
To avoid the isolated d pawn in the Tarrash system, black has been known to recapture on d5 with his queen but without achieving very much. However, in a Russian magazine I discovered a game from the 1980 Malta Olympiad where black castles long instead of short as he normally does and succeeds in beating a strong German player.

HECHT HERZOG

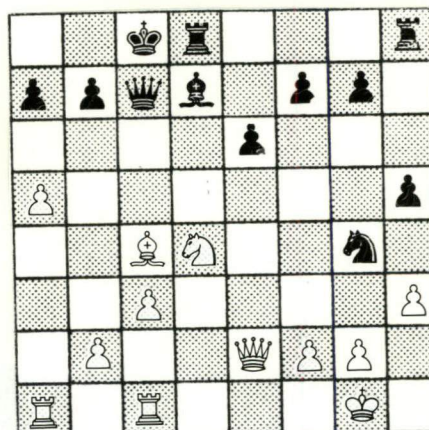
1	e4	e6
2	d4	d5
3	Nd2	c5
4	ed	Qxd5



5	Ngf3	cd
6	Bc4	Qd6
7	O-O	Nf6
8	Nb3	Nc6
9	Nbxd4	Nxd4
10	Nxd4	Bd7
11	c3	Qc7
12	Qe2	O-O-O



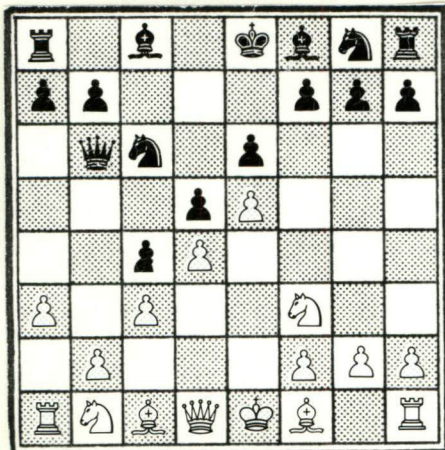
13	a4	Bd6
14	h3	Bh2+
15	Kh1	Bf4
16	a5	Bxc1
17	Rfxc1	h5
18	Kg1	Ng4



19	Nf3	Bc6
20	hg	hg
21	Ne5	Rh5
22	f4	gf
23	Nf3	Bxf3
24	Resigns	

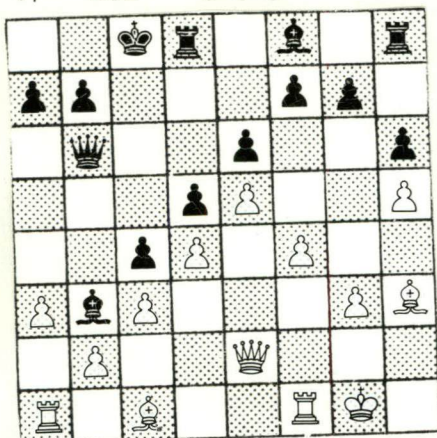
I have taken up this idea with reasonable success, losing one, winning two, drawing two. A few years ago, I had a bit of trouble with the dreaded 6.a3 line in the Advance variation. I could not believe Petrosian's 6....c4 was the answer as it took all pressure off d4, giving white a free hand on the K-side.

e.g. (after 1 e4 e6 2 d4 d5
3 e5 c5 4 c3 Nc6 5 Nf3
Qb6 6 a3 c4)



Bronstein-Mestel (London 1976) went:

7	Nbd2	Na5
8	h4	Bd7
9	h5	h6
10	g3	Ne7
11	Bh3	Nb3
12	Nxb3	Ba4
13	Nfd2	Nc6
14	O-O	Na5
15	f4	Nxb3
16	Nxb3	Bxb3
17	Qe2	O-O-O



18	f5	Re8
19	Be3	Ba4
20	fe6	fe6
21	Rf7	Re7
22	Rf2	Re8
23	Raf1	Be7
24	Qg4	Bd8
25	Qg6	Re7
26	Rf7	Be8

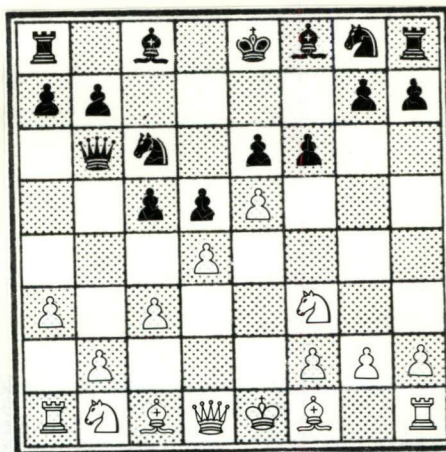
27 Re7 1-0
(27 ...Bxg6 28 Rxe6 Wins).

or Vitolinsh-Zelinsky (Latvian Championship 1978).

7	g3	Bd7
8	Bh3	Na5
9	Nbd2	Be7
10	O-O	h5
11	Ne1	O-O-O
12	Ng2	g6
13	Ne3	Nh6
14	b4!?	cb3
15	Bb2	Nf5
16	c4	Nxc4
17	Ndxc4	dc4
18	Nxc4	Qa6
19	d5!	(1-0 (43))

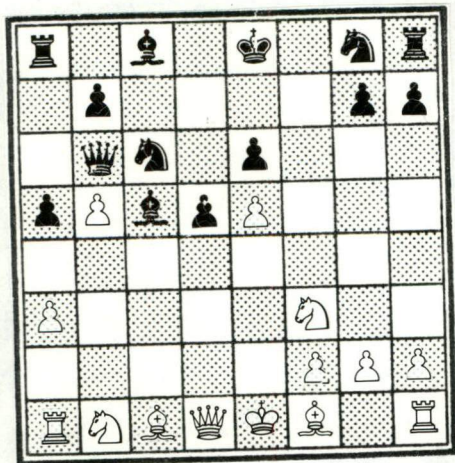
The weird line I dreamed up (and which I offer free to all 5-minute players) has overtones of the Muzio Gamit (of all things) and went as follows:-

6 f6!



7	b4	(7 Bd3 is probably better)
7		cd
8	cd	fe
9	de	a5
10	b5	Bc5!?

(A strange move, but my own)



Now, I had thought 15 Qb3 was unplayable because of 15 ... Ra7! (threat Rb7) but white can play 16 Qc3 (though after 16Rb7+ 17 Ka2? Loses to 17 Rxb1, 18 Qxc5 Rxa1+ 19 Kxa1 Bc5 etc - and instead must play 17 Kc2). This being so, black can try: 15 Ba6 16 Bxa6 Rxa6 17 Qb8+ Kf7 18 Qb7+ Ne7 19 Qxa6 Rb8+ 20 Ka2 Qc2+ 21 Bb2 Qb2 mate or ... 15 ... Ne7 16 Bd3 0-0 17 Qc2 Rab8+ 18 Ka2 Ba6 19 Qxc5 Bxd3! 20 Qxf2 Bc4 mate.

Well, I must go now as I am running out of space, cigarettes, catfood etc. Hope you found this of interest.

Best wishes.

GEORGE HILL

- 11 bc Bxf2+
 12 Kd2 Qe3+
 13 Kc2 Qc5+
 14 Kb2
 (14 Kd2? Be6+ wins the c1 Bishop
 and 14 Nc3? d4 wins the knight)
 14 bc

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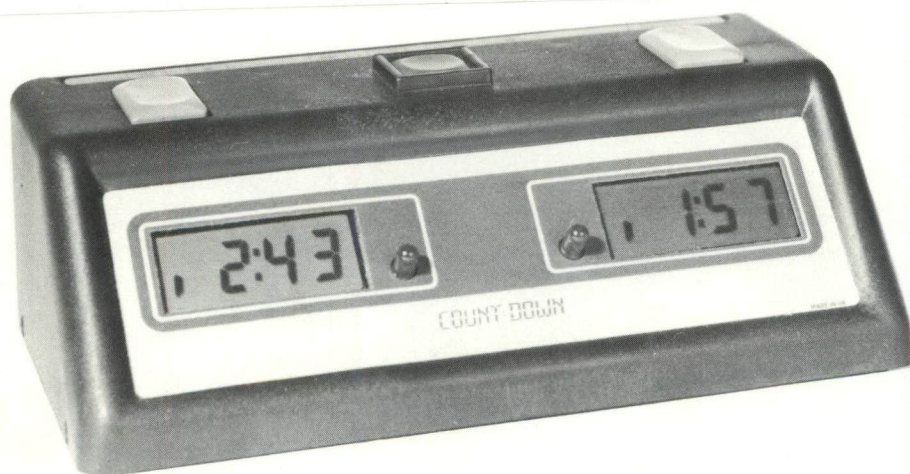
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WAR!

Last issue editor Mike Basman said he would like to see a few more of my games against the Novag (approaching E10 2000), Constellation - and it could be that you too would be interested. Too bad if your'e not - because at vast expense of time and effort I have played several games against level 7 (the best level which allows the computer 40 moves in 2 hours).

First I thought I would test it out against the black bombproof fortress that I have so often advised for beginners and for those who have no time or inclination to study opening theory.

NOVAG LEVEL 7 v JOSEPHS

1 e4 g6 2 d4 Bg7 3 Nf3 d6 4 Bc4 Nf6 5 Nc3 0-0

These first five moves by black are very difficult to prevent and give black good development with a strong fortress against any early white attack.

6 0-0 Nxe4 (!?) This is known as the fork trick - whether it is any good for black I'm not sure - but it puts the wind up the average white player who does not know it - he thinks he is up against a real professional!

7 Nxe4 d5! 8 Bxd5 Qxd5 Black has the two bishops (maybe 7 Bxf7+ Rxf7 8 Nxe4 is better for white - I don't know). 9 Re1 Bg4
10 Nc3 Qd7 11 Qd3 Nc6. Rooks connected in less than a dozen moves
 12 Ne5 Nxe5 13 dxe5 Qxd3 14 cxd3 Rad8.

Black now has (a) 2 bishops (b) pressure down the d file against white's backward pawn (c) a majority of pawns on the queenside (3 v 2) well away from opposition from the white king and therefore potentially more dangerous than the white 5 v 4 kingside majority

These three advantages add up to a good plus for black and show that you must regard the consequence on your pawn chain of all exchanges and pawn moves after the opening 15 Nb5 Rxd3 16 Bg5 c6. Can I tempt Novag Constellation to play Nxa7? I have never met a computer yet that understood the danger of TRAPPING a piece - they are programmed against forks, skewers, pins etc, but surrounding a piece and trapping it seems beyond their ken as a rule 17 Nxa7? Can he get out again? Novag doesn't worry and does not care.... 17 Ra8 18 f3 Be6 19 Red1 Rxd1 20 Rxd1 Kf8 (Protect the e pawn first - the knight can't run away but the white rook and bishop are dangerous if I let them in - e.g. 20 Rxa7??
21 Rd8+ Bf8 22 Bh6) 21 a3 Ke8 (Stops the white rook from coming to d8 after the black rook takes on a7).

22 Be3 Bxe5 Picks up a pawn and the knight is still trapped whilst the black bishops now out in the open take the board.

23 Rc1? (Why?) Bb8 24 Nxc6 (Desperado) bxc6 25 Rxc6 Be5
26 Rc2 Rd8 Take the only other open file.

27 f4 Bd4 28 Bxd4 Rxd4 and a piece up for two pawns I just pushed my king out to the queenside under cover of my rook which of course 'he'

did not want to exchange - seeing his king well away with my rook. His two pawns in the a and b files soon fell and I resigned on the computers' behalf.

Really the computer lost because he let his knight get trapped so early

Next I took white to see how the BEAST defended itself.....

JOSEPHS v NOVAG CONSTELLATION LEVEL 7

1 e4 e5 2 Nf3 Nc6 3 d4 (A drop of Scotch!) exd4
4 Bc4 Nf6 5 0-0 Bc5 turing into a MAX LANGE 6 e5 Ng4?
(d5 seems better) 7 Bxf7+ Kxf7 8 Ng5+ Kg8

I reckon the computer is not usually aware of the disadvantage of moving his king before castling and thus losing the privelege must be difficult to program for this.....

9 Qxg4 Nxe5 10 Qg3 d6 11 f4(!) Try and open things up to attack the awkward black king even if d3+ looks a menace

11 Nc4 12 f5 d3+ 13 Kh1 dxc2 14 Nc3 Bd7
16 f6 g6 16 f7+ Kg7 17 Qh4 H6 18 F8=Q Rxf8
19 Ne6+ Bxe6 20 Bxh6+ Kh7 21 Bg5+ (GOTCHA!) 21..... Kg8
22 Bxd8 Raxd8 23 Ne4 Bd4 24 Ng5 Rxf1+ 25 Rxf1 Rd7
26 Qxd4 Another piece bites the dust! 26 c5 Lets clear the board with 27 Rf8+! Kxf8 28 Nxe6+ Ke7 29 Qxc4 C1=Q
Glory for a second or two! 30 Qxe1 and the rest is technique as we rabbits say when we don't like end games! Actually the game lasted another twenty moves but was so boring that I will not inflict the details upon you.

Conclusion so far: computers find it difficult to anticipate

- (a) surrounding pieces with pawns etc so they can't move
- (b) temporary sacrifice to stop them castling in the future after moving the king

So lets try white again and see what the Novag replies...

JOSEPHS v NOVAG CONSTELLATION

1 e4 d5 (!) The cheek of it - My favorite opening as black and it plays it against me!

2 exd5 Nf6 3 c4 c6 4 Qa4 (!) This is right away from the books but I find it both startling and effective against black in the Centre Counter - luckily nobody does it to me 4 ... e5 probably best and I'm not sure whether to take the pawn e.p. or not - it develops the black bishop but undoubles my pawns by way of compensation - so this time

5 dxe6 e.p. Bxe6 6 Nc3 Nd7 7 Qd1 my queen has done her job of helping to keep a pawn and blocking the c6 square from black's queen's knight - now I've got to try and push my backward QP.

6 Nb6 8 B3 Bc5 9 Nf3 Bg4 (Moving it twice and giving me time to catch up in development) 10 Be2 0-0 11 0-0 Re8 12 Re1 Qd6 13 a3 (Can I trap a piece again?) Ne4
 14 Nxe4 Rxe4 15 Bb2 Rae8? His bishop on c5 is in danger

Nevertheless, I'm only a pawn up but black is putting on the pressure - luckily he overlooked his bishop being trapped 16 d4(?)! Bxd4??!
 (Bxf3 holds) 17 Nxd4 Bxe2 18 Nxe2 Qxd1 19 Raxd1 Suddenly Novag sees that he cannot play Rxe2 because I retake his rook and he either loses it or gets mated on the back row! Such frustration must have led to a brainstorm I reckon because his next move is to me completely unexplicable ... after 5 minutes thought he played 19 Nxc4???

20 bxc4 b5 21 Cxb cxb 22 Kf1 b4 23 Ng3 Rxe1
 24 Rxe1 Rxe1 25 Kxe1 and I reckon I could even beat Gary Kasparov if he had the black pieces - no - Black Resigns!

In complications be the FIRST to take a piece. 16 Bxf3 and your LESS likely to end up a piece down!

I am not sure taking the black 'e' pawn on move 5 is the best way to tackle the opening - so I replan the first four moves of the last game as follows:-

1 e4 d5 2 exd5 Nf6 3 c4 c6 4 Qa4 e5 5 Ne2
 (try and exchange the weak and backward 'd' pawn).

5 b5 (this disintegrates the black queen side) 6 cxb5 cxd5
 7 b6+ Qd7 8 Qxd7 Nb8d7 9 bxa7 Bc5. Well I now have TWO CONNECTED PASSED PAWNS on the queen side - If I can get developed in time (6 moves to connect my rooks and he needs only 2) I should win O.K.

10 g3 Rxa7 11 Bg2 Bb7 12 0-0 0-0 Well he's developed and I've still got my QN and QB on the back row - still with a pawn up, two connected passed pawns, plus my king in safety I should be O.K. if I keep a foothold in the centre, so

13 d3 Rc8 14 Nbc3 Bc6 15 Bg5 (see if I can swap off this useless bishop!) 15 h6 (I was going to swap it anyway so it wastes time) 16 Bxf6 Nxf6 17 a3 (Now to push the pawns!) Bb6
 18 b4 Rac7 putting pressure along the only open file - as it is no doubt programmed to do - but the 'a' and 'b' pawns should be blocked really -

19 a4 d4 20 Bxc6 Rxc6 21 Ne4 Nd5 22 b5 Rc2 23 Re1 Ra8 24 Nd6 (heading for c4) Bc7 25 Nc4 an outpost that also blocks the dangerous 'c' file. 25 f6 26 a5 Nb4 Here I had to pause and calculate for the first time in the "match" - I reckon I'm "bound to queen" - so 27 b6 Nxd3 28 b7 Rb8 29 a6 Nxe1
 30 a7 (side by side...) Nf3+ 31 Kg2 e4 32 axb8=Q+ Bxb8
 33 Ra8 Kf7 34 Rxb8 Rxc4 and black is a pawn up - BUT A TRICK YOU MUST REMEMBER FOR END GAMES - 35 Rf8+! Kxf8 36 b8=Q+ (A queen I can keep!) Ke7 37 Qb7+ Kd6 38 Qxe4 Ng5 39 Qf5 Ne6
 40 Nf4 Nxf4 41 Qxf4+ Kd5 42 Qf5+ Kd6 and once again I put NOVAG CONSTELLATION out of his agony by resigning the game for him

I'll give the machine a last chance for revenge by giving it white again.

NOVAG CONSTELLATION v IAN JOSEPHS

1 e4 That lets ME play the Centre Counter as black for a change - How d'you like that Novag? 1.... d5 2 exd5 Nf6 3d4 (strongest according to most books) Nxd5 4 c4 Nb6 5 Nf3 Bg4 6 Nbd2 g6 (to put pressure on the pawns) 7 Be2 Bg7 8 h3 Bf5 (Bh4 loses at once to g4. Remember this idea when you or your opponent fianchettoes 9 Qb3 Qc8 (I'm worried about my pawn on b7 if he plays c5 to make my knight move) 10 c5 Be6 (Maybe if I'd seen his last move I'd have castled instead of Qc8) 11 Qd3 Nd5 12 Qb5+ (why?) Nc6 13 Bc4 0-0 14 Nb3 Rd8 15 0-0 a5 (put pressure on his backward 'd' pawn by attempting to shift his knight).

16 Bd2? (ignores the threat) a4 17 Nc1 Ncd4 First blood! 18 Nxd4 Bxd4 19 c6 bxc6 20 Qxc6 Rd6 I reckon his queen is in trouble. So does he, because without even TRYING to escape the net he plays 21 Bxd5 (!) 21 Rxc6 (Hope it's not a subtle trap) 22 Bxc6 Bxb2 (lets clear the board to be 'safe').

23 Rb1 Bxc1 24 Rfxc1 Rb8 25 Rxb8 Qxb8. Queen and two pawns should be worth a lot more than R + B so perhaps he was discouraged when he went amazingly 26 Bf3?? allowing Bxa2 and giving me a passed pawn at a4.

27 Bf4 Qb2 28 Rxc7 e5 29 Bc1 Qa1 30 g3 Be6 31 Kg2 a3 32 Bg4 a2 (will I get 2 queens?) 33 Bxe6 fxe6 34 Rc8+ Kf7 35 Rc7+ Kf6 36 g4 Qb1 37 g5+ Kf5 38 F3!!

threatens mate on the move (Rf7+) e4 seems obligatory but just for amusement I asked Novag for a 'hint' for black. I pressed the 'HINT' button, and he duly obliged with the misleading a1=Q which would have left me mated next move. This is the kind of advice I can do WITHOUT so I played 38 e4 as planned telling off NOVAG for **deceitful** gamesmanship of the worst kind!

39 Rf7+ Ke5 40 f4+ Kd6 41 Ra7 a1=Q NOW IT'S OKAY 42 Rxa1 Qxa1 and with Q and 4 pawns against bishop + 3 pawns I reckoned I could even beat the white pieces against Basman and Kaspar in Consultation - so NOVAG resigns...

Now I still reckon NOVAG Constellation is the best computer on the consumer market as its BLITZ play is nearly as good as its tournament play (and better than my blitz play which is lousy). The main weaknesses seem to be fivefold!

- (1) Good pieces keep getting 'trapped' by pawn etc.
- (2) Like most computers it will nearly always move its king to save a pawn even if it forfeits castling in a dangerously open position.
- (3) Combinations only 2 moves deep when involving DISCOVERED checks (see also LAST ISSUE P.C) go unnoticed until too late - FORKS, CHECKS, PINS are programmed, discovered checks are less allowed for.
- (4) It attaches no importance to passed pawns on the second and third ranks when they are still on the second or third ranks even if connected.

- (5) It gets unnerved when faced with a 'Popular Chess Player' / Rabbit 1st class such as your friendly chess advisor for the weaker brethren - Why? because I TALK TO IT CONSTANTLY.

IAN JOSEPHS

P.S Twice I had to replay my games because of temporary power cuts/ fluctuations. I should get paid OVERTIME for the hours spent contemplating that petulant computer on Level 7 - however twice zero is zero so I'll settle for a complementary copy of Popular Chess when my subscription runs out

Postal Chess

If you are under grade 135, then there is a postal chess club for you which allows friendly and competition games. It's run by Mr Francis Hynes of 104 Circle Court, Barton Road, Stretford, Manchester M32 9gj. Write to him at that address for details of the 'Stars Barred Postal Chess Club'.

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(This article wrongly ascribes the variation to the American master, Jim Tayler, rather than the Leicester player.)

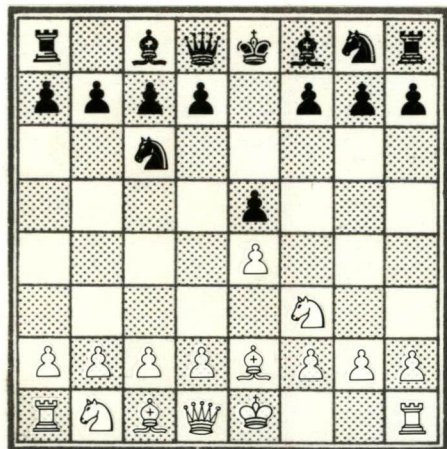
TAYLER VARIATION

A few years ago, an article appeared in the magazine "Chess", written by the American expert, Jim Tayler, then sojourning in the British Isles. It suggested novel king pawn opening, beginning with the moves 1 e4 e5 2 Nf3 Nc6 3 Be2. I shelved the article for sometime, but recently came across it again and looked into it more deeply.

The need for a line like this is apparent. If white plays 1 e4, he must have an answer to 1 e5. Unfortunately, many of the lines he can choose from - Ruy Lopez, Giuoco Piano, Scotch - are either too well known or inadequate for the initiative. I had already pioneered a line against the Sicilian beginning 1 e4 c5 2 Nf3 and 3 Be2; wouldn't it be great if the move 3 Be2 also proved effective against a straight 1 e5?

As with the 3 Be2 line against the Sicilian, Tayler's variation is striking by its harmless, toothless appearance

1 e4 e5
2 Nf3 Nc6
3 Be2



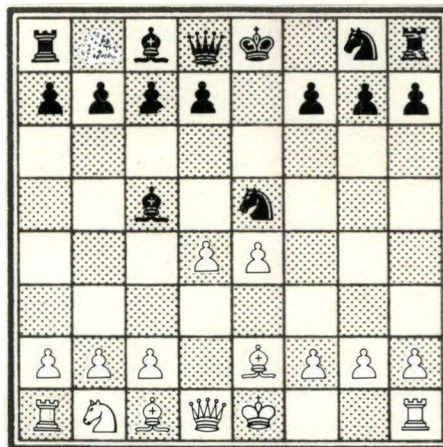
We've all been trained to bring our bishop out to c4, to aim at the weak point in black's game, the F7 square - but isn't this

a rather illusory weakness, a tempter to make us forget the rules of development and mobilization, aiming instead for a quick knockout with only a couple of fighting units. Besides, the bishop is often exposed to the counterthrust d7-d5 on c4.

The current move, 3 Be2, lifts the bishop off the first row and prepares castling; it also signals the intention to fight for central terrain, rather than immediate attack, and to this end, white will be playing d2-d4 shortly.

We already notice that the automatic reply 3 Bc5 is not adequate here. White has two good possibilities; one is to play 4 c3, intending to obtain dominance in the central area of the board by d2-d4, and gain time for it by attacking the black bishop at the same time.

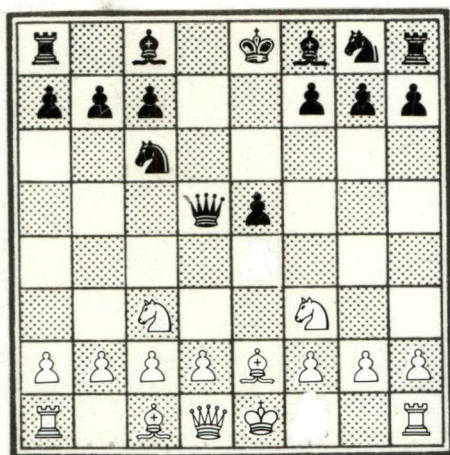
The other idea is to play the fork trick, which works in this position, but would not do so if white's bishop were at c4. So 4 Nxe5 Nxe5 5 d4



White has eliminated the black central pawn whilst maintaining his own. Had white's bishop been on c4, black could take it with his knight here.

After 4 Nxe5 black could answer
 4 Bxf2+ 5 Kxf2 Nxe5 but then
 white has the opportunity to control the
 centre with pawns with a subsequent d4,
 and his loss of castling rights be
 corrected by a process called "artificial
 castling" - that is, playing Rh1-f1,
 followed by KF2-g1.

Now lets return to our first diagram,
 after the move 3 Be2. A favourite
 reply, much beloved of computers, is to
 play 3 d5. White should hope to
 do well out of this, because after
 4 exd5 Qxd5 5 Nc3, he gains time for
 development by attacking the black queen.

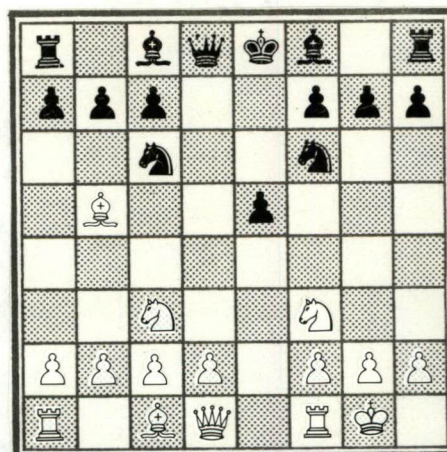


White's only worry is that black now has
 the dominant central pawn, which rather
 cramps white's game. However, white's
 king can quickly castle, and with his extra
 development he should be able to knock out
 black's central pawn, and perhaps also attack
 down the central files against the black
 king, which will take longer to escape from
 the middle. Here is a quick win against the
 Novag computer on level 1, which illustrates
 the basic themes.

4 exd5 Qxd5
 5 Nc3 Qd8

Much more stubborn is 5 Qc5. We'll
 look at this later.

6 O-O NF6
 7 Bb5!



This is an idea that frequently recurs
 in this variation, and many will say
 why move a piece twice in the opening
 and couldn't have you done this on
 move 3 and played the Ruy Lopez?

However, Bb5 in this position is much
 stronger than in the Ruy Lopez. It
 delivers an actual pin, and there is
 a direct threat of winning a pawn by
 8 Nxe5. Furthermore, by impaling the
 black beast at c6, blacks hold on the
 centre is dealt a mortal blow, so that
 white is all ready to smash open the
 central files by d2-d4. To prevent this,
 black tries a pin of his own.

7 Bg4
 8 H3 Bxf3

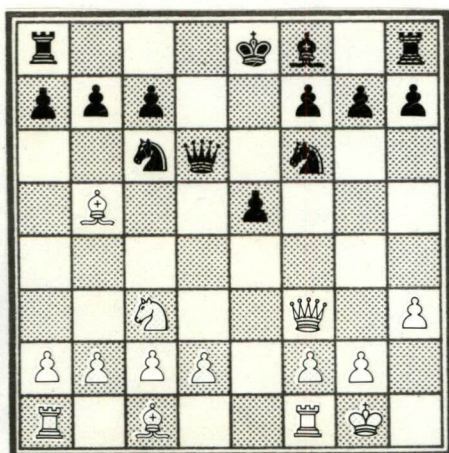
Black exchanges and removes the
 immediate threat to his pawn at e5.
 But this only throws up more problems.

9 Qxf3

Now there is a focussed attack on c6
 to be dealt with.

9 Qd6

True to form, the computer holds on to
 what he's got.



10 d4!

It had to come. This pawn sacrifice allows white to use the central file against the uncastled black king.

10 exd4

Of course, 10 Qxd4 would be even worse after 11 Bxc6+ bxc6 12 Qxc6+ & QXR.

11 Re1+ Be7

12 Bf4

Develop with a gain of time they say.

12 Qc5?

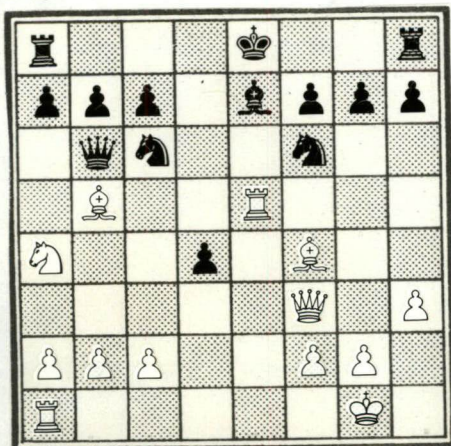
This loses rapidly. The position is still problematical after 12 ... Qd7, which indicates that white's last move, 12 Bf4, may have been too routine, and that 12 Ne4 Nxe4 13 Qxe4, preventing 0-0, might have been better.

13 Re5!

Taking advantage of the pin again.

13 Qb6

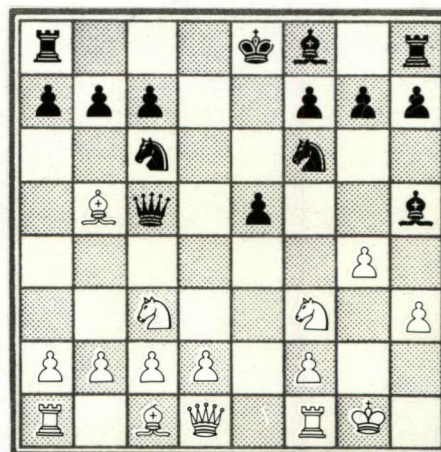
14 Na4!



And black's queen is lost.

Another game against the Novag level 1 featured the black queen moving to c5 instead of black to d8.

After 3 Be2 d5 4 exd5 Qxd5
5 Nc3 Qc5 6 0-0 Nf6 white
played again 7 Bb5 Bg4 8 h3 Bh5
9 g4



Black is loath now to play 9 Bg6, which may run into something like 10 Nxe5 Qxe5 11 Re1 (note the use of the e file again) and instead continued

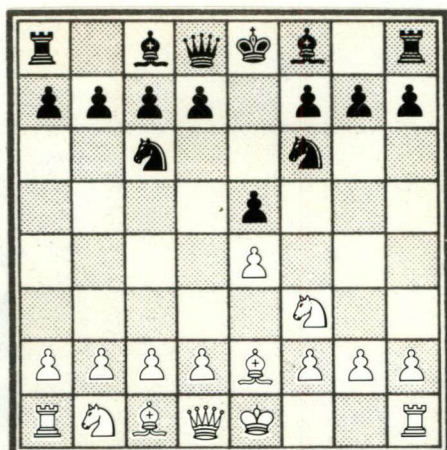
9 Nxg4 10 hxg4 Bxg4 However this receives short shrift from 11 d4! Bxf3 (... exd4 12 Re1+ Be7 13 Qxd4!) 12 Qxf3 exd4 13 Re1+ Kd8? 14 Qxf7 Kc8 15 Re8+ and mates in a couple.

approaching the

main variations

The most testing reply to 3 Be2 is

3 NF6



By counter attacking against the white "e" pawn black hopes to considerably reduce the impetuosity of the attack. In fact, white is virtually forced to sacrifice a pawn if he wants to keep the initiative.

4 d4!

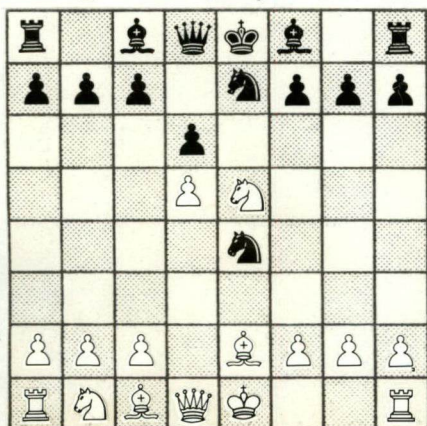
Other moves to guard the "e" pawn are possible, but 4 d3 is too quiet and 4 Nc3 allows black to develop his bishop aggressively with 4 Bb4!

Now we can pass quickly over the defensive move 4 d6, as besides 5 dxe5, white can also play 5 Nc3 with a strong position, as black has not the aggressive bishop development Bb4 with his pawn on d6.

Furthermore, 4 Nxe4 is dubious as white has two ways to regain his pawn and secure the edge.

One is 5 dxe5 white gains a strong pawn at e5 and has possible threats of Qd5 isolating the knight at e4.

Another move is 5 d5 Ne7 (or Nb8) 6 Nxe5 with a better central position for white due to his advanced pawn at d5. There is also a possible curious sequel if black tries 5 d6 here. (We are assuming black played Ne7 not Nb8)



6 Bb5+!

An awkward check. Black just does not have sufficient fire power on the blocking squares d7 and c6.

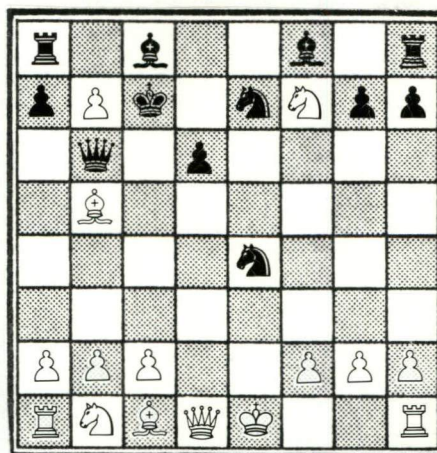
6 c6
7 dxc6

Now if black plays 7 bxc6, 8 Nxc6 is strong. Instead black tries to complicate

7 Qb6!?

Threatens mate on F2

8 cxb7 dis. ch. Kd8
9 Nxf7+ Kc7



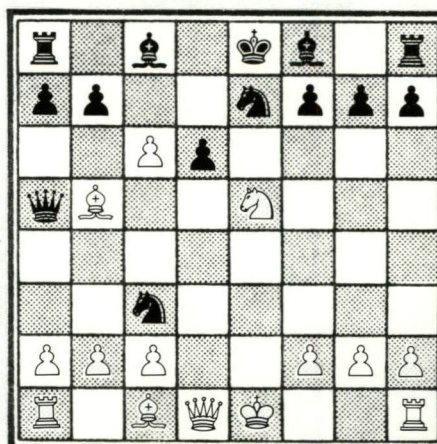
10 b7xa8=Nch!! and white wins.

On move 7 black can try an even more complicated line

7 Qa5+!

Forking king and bishop

8 Nc3! Nxc3



Things look grim for white. Three pieces enprise and a piece down to boot. Fortunately, his discovered check saves the day.

9 cxb7 discovered check!

answered by

9 Nxb5 discovered check!!

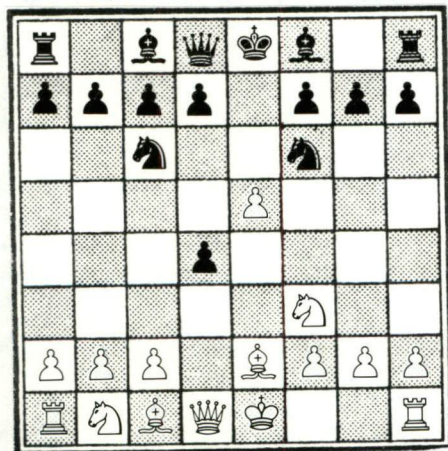
answered by

10 Bd2!!!

and white seems to come out a queen ahead.

THE MAIN LINE

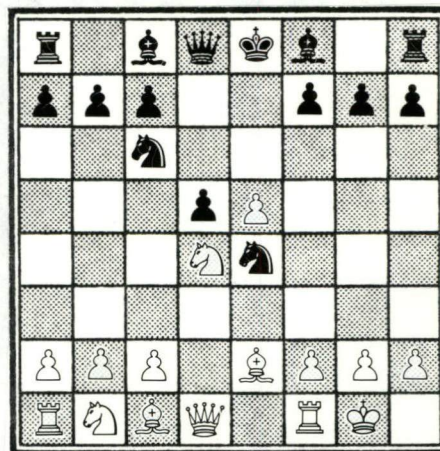
This begins 1 e4 e5 2 Nf3 Nc6
3 Be2 NF6 4 d4 exd4 5 e5



The advance of this pawn disturbs black's development by hitting the exposed knight at f6. Black has three plausible replies - to move the knight to d5, e4, or g4.

I feel the least critical of these moves is 5 Nd5, because it holds no threat to white's e pawn and the knight may sometime be exposed to attack from white's queen along the d file. After 5 Nd5 white could castle /60-07 and against black's natural move 6 d6 to eliminate the white e pawn, white can now use the universal antidote of 7 Bb5, pinning the c6 knight and clearing the e file for his rook.

Taylor devoted a lot of space in his article to the answer 5 Ne4. One line he looks at goes 6 0-0 d5 (to maintain the knight at e4) 7 Nxd4.



Now black can take the bait at e5 by

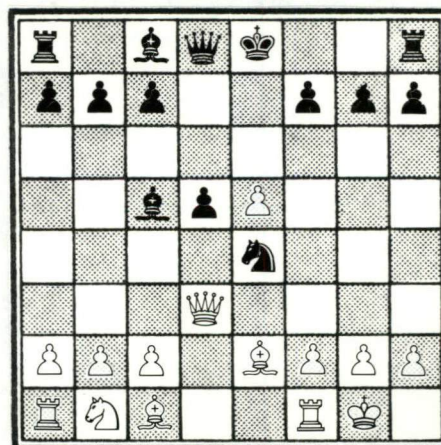
7 Nxe5

against which Taylor suggests the following critical continuation:-

8 F3 NF6 9 Bb5+! c6
10 Re1 cxb5 11 Rxe5+ Be7
12 Qe2 and white's pressure down the e file prevents black from castling.

In black's other line, he does not capture the pawn at e5, so the game turns into a purely positional struggle for the initiative.

From the last diagram, instead of 7 Nxe5 black plays for quick development by 7 ... Nxd4 8 Qxd4 Bc5 9 Qd3



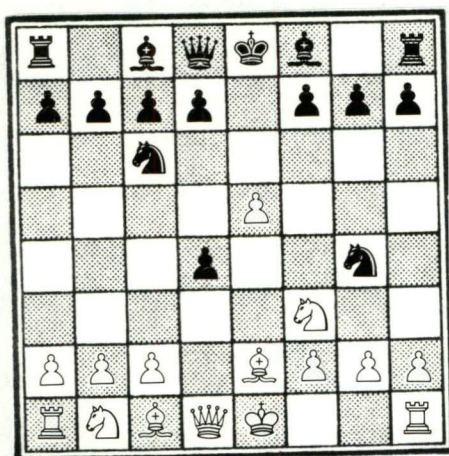
White's hopes for the initiative lie with his pawn at e5, and possible pawn roller by f4-f5 with a king side attack.

A game between Tayler and Hebden in 1981 continued 9 0-0 10 Nc3 (10 Nd2 and 10 Be3 are also suggested) Bf5 11 Nxd5 re8 12 Bf4 Bg6 and here 13 Qb3 (instead of 13 Rad1 Nxf2) would have given white the advantage.

✕ * * * * ✕

Our last variation is the most critical one from the amateur players point of view - because it involves the certain loss of a pawn and naturally he will be worried about the compensation obtained.

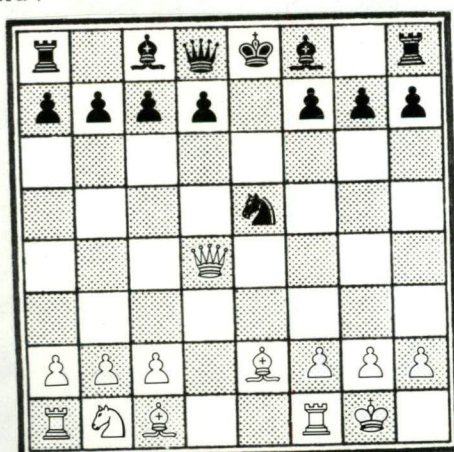
This occurs after 5 Ng4, threatening the white e pawn twice.



There is no real point in trying to save this pawn - if white plays 5 Bf4 black will simply attack the centre with d6 and white's hopes of an opening advantage are shelved.

So white must go for immediate castling, hoping to take advantage of the open 'e' file as soon as black captures the central pawn.

6 0-0! Ngxe5
7 Nxe5 Nxe5
8 Qxd4



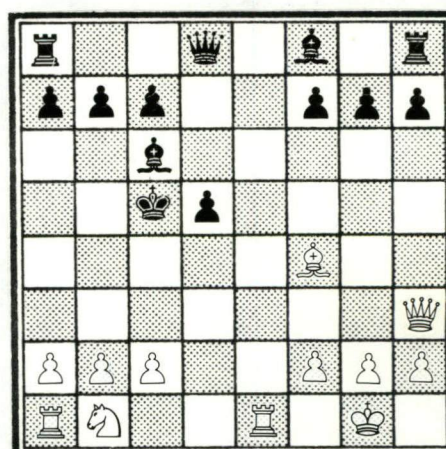
White's queen comes to the middle of the board with gain of tempo. We can see that black still needs two moves to castle his own king.

8 Nc6

9 Qc3!

A strong retreat, designed solely to prevent the development of black's bishop at f8, on pain of capture of the 'g' pawn and destruction of black's intended castled position. Of course, black can simply go straight for the ending with 9 Qf6, but after 10 Qxf6 gxf6 11 Nc3 (threat Nd5) his defence is not easy, despite having an extra pawn.

Playing this position against Sensory 9, the computer chose 9 ... d5 here, but got into trouble almost immediately after 10 Bb5! Bd7 11 Bxc6 (not 11 Re1+ Ne7!) Bxc6 12 Re1+ Kd7 13 Qh3 Kd6 14 Bf4+ Kc5.



If white doesn't manage to mate quickly here, his win should be easy if he steamrollers his queen side pawns down against the black king opening the files and crushing the pieces in their path.

Sensory 9, actually, preferred usually to play a more conservative, but probably stronger line than the immediate capture at e5.

After 5 Ng4 6 0-0 it chose: 6 Be7!

This intends to capture the pawn a move later, when black will castle quickly into safety. White's problem is to find something meaningful to do with his extra move.

7 Nxd4

This seems best, as it forces black to capture the pawn immediately, and then white hopes to make something out of the advance of his F pawn

7 Ng4xe5

8 F4 Nxd4

(8..... Ng6 is also possible).

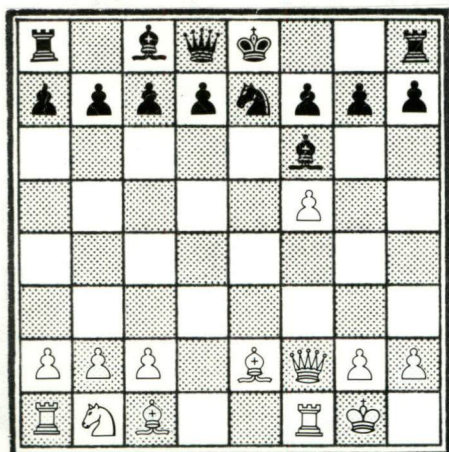
9 Qxd4 Ng6!

10 F5

(10 Qxg7 BF6 11 Qh6 is another story)

10 BF6

11 QF2 Ne7



This is another typical position where white has given up a pawn but has advanced strongly on the king side, and should black castle there he may find himself attacked strongly.

A game Basman-Novag constellation level 7 continued from the diagram:

12 Nc3 d5

13 g4! 0-0

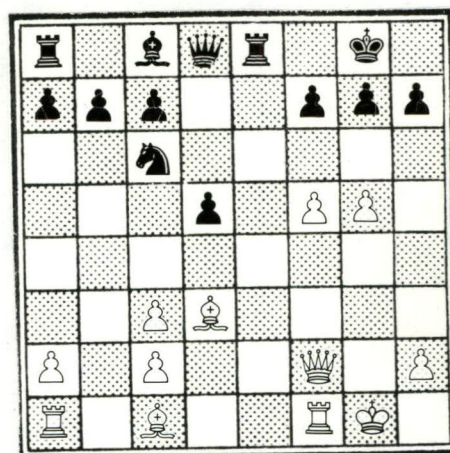
14 Bd3

(preparing g5, by protecting the F5 pawn)

14 ... Bxc3(?)

15 bxc3 Nc6

16 g5 Re8



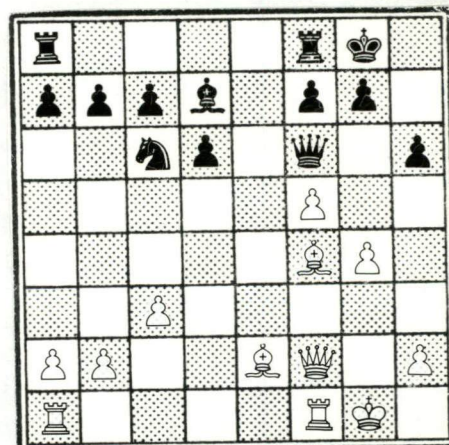
Here I had a choice of pawn thrusts, 17 g6 or 17 f6. In one game against Novag I chose 17 f6 and won quickly with mate threats at g7. 17 g6 18 Qh4 Qd6 19 a4! followed by Ba3 and Qh6. In another game I chose 17 g6 but did not fare so well after 17 hxg6 18 Fxg6 F5! 19 h4 Qf6 20 h5 Qxc3 (grab everything) 21 Be3 Nb4! with counter play for black. In a couple of practice games between Basman and Cavendish (London U12 Champion) the consequences were:

(PLEASE GO BACK TO THE LAST DIAGRAM BUT ONE)

12 Nc3 0-0 13 g4 h6

14 Ne4 Nc6 15 Nxf6+ Qxf6

16 c3 d6 17 Bf4 Bd7



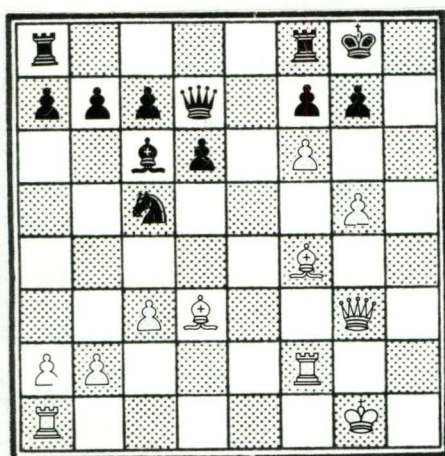
White steadily masses for the g5 pawn break through.

18 Qg3 Ne5 19 Rf2 Bc6

20 h4 Nd7 21 Bd3 Nc5

22 g5! hxg5 23 hxg5 Qe7

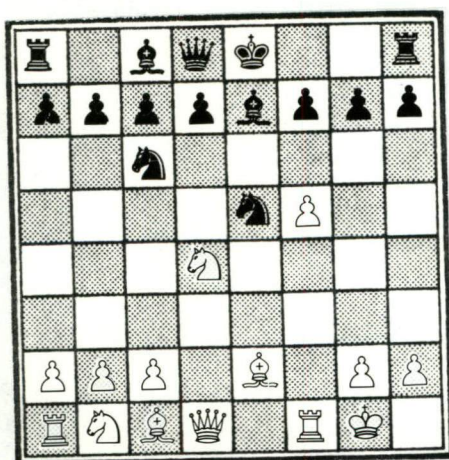
24 f6! Qd7



25 Bh7+ Kxh7 26 Rh2+ Kg8
27 Qh4 and mates

However, Cavendish gained revenge as white in the following encounter:

1 e4 e5 2 Nf3 Nc6
3 Be2 Nf6 4 d4 exd4
5 e5 Ng4 6 0-0 Be7
7 Nxd4 Ngxe5 8 f4 Ng6
9 f5 Nge5

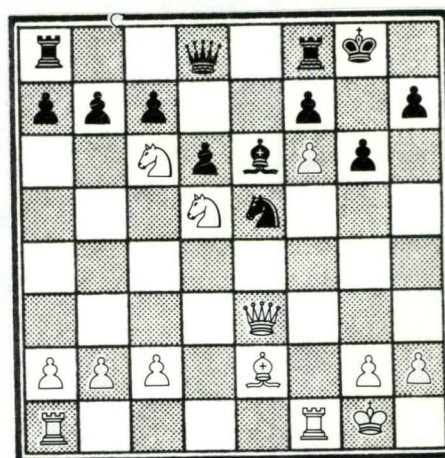


10 Nc3 0-0 11 Nd5 This knight coming to d5 severely constricts the black position.

11 Bc5 12 Be3 d6 13 f6
The thrust comes and mating threats are in the air.

13 g6 14 Qd2 Be6 all oblivious to the coming storm.

15 Nxc6 Bxe3+ 16 Qxe3



Black resigns, because 16 bxc6 is answered by Qh6 followed by mate. To recap on the ideas of Taylers's variation

1. White forgoes the immediate attempts to assault f7 but aims for quick development and castling. The bishop's post at e2 is modest, but avoids exposure and aids castling.

2. White aims to play d2-d4 and assault black's pawn at e5, either exchanging it or gaining a space advantage with two pawns in the centre.

3. Black may try to cut across white's plans by counter attacking in the centre with 3 Nf6. In that case, to retain his initiative white may need to sacrifice a pawn gaining in exchange attacking chances against the black king in the centre or in its castled position.

4. The move Be2-b5 at certain critical moments can disable black's control of the e5 and d4 squares, making the move d4 easier for white. The bishop move also clears the 'e' file. A lesser intention of playing Be2-b5 is to play Bxc6 doubling black's pawns, but it is usually less important than the other ideas already mentioned. I say this because a lot of people get fixed on the idea of doubled pawns and elevate the concept into idolatrous proportions.

I look forward to hearing of your successes with this new variation!

NOVICE SECTION

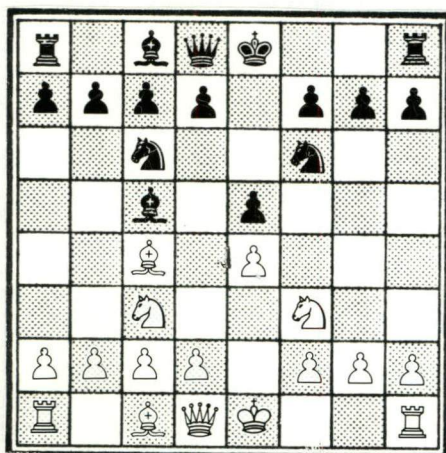
This game between two young players of grade 70-80 illustrates many different ideas of opening, positional and attacking play.

White D. Starling

Black S. Hampton

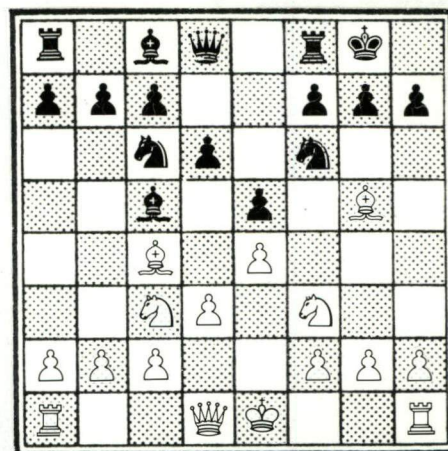
Opening: Giuoco Pianissimo

1. P-K4 P-K4
2. N-KB3 N-QB3
3. N-QB3 N-KB3
4. B-B4 B-B4



Most novice games seem to begin something like this. The players bring out their knights and bishops, and then castle. There is usually some difficulty later in getting the rooks into action, as the pawn structure does not allow file to be opened very early. The Giuoco Pianissimo is the name of this set up ("very quiet game") whereas its big brother, the Giuoco Piano ("quiet game") plays more ambitiously in the centre with P-QB3 and P-Q4, rather than N-QB3.

5. P-Q3 O-O
6. B-KN5 P-Q3?



White's last move - B-KN5 - should have been a danger signal to black, because white could now put his knight on Q5 and cause the breakup of the black pawns around the castled king by BxP6 or NxF6. Instead of 6.....P-Q3 black should have broken the pin with 6.....B-K2, whereas ... P-Q3 actually shuts the bishop out.

7. BXN?

White misses the chance to play 7 N-Q5, and instead makes an unnecessary exchange which is even to his disadvantage, as, other things being equal, a bishop is worth more than a knight.

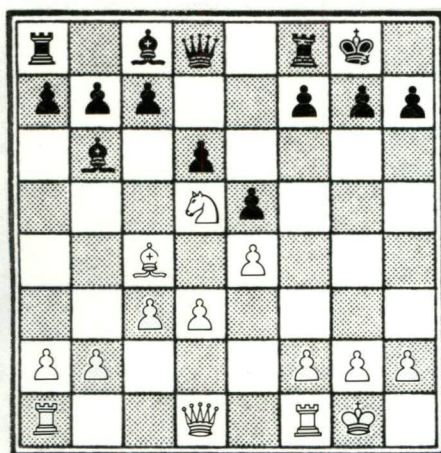
7. QxB
8. O-O N-Q5

Black could also have caused more trouble to white here by playing 8.....B-KN5, threatening ... N-Q5.

9. NXN B-XN
10. N-Q5

This fork on the black queen and QBP is not really dangerous as black can retreat the queen and guard the QB pawn at the same time.

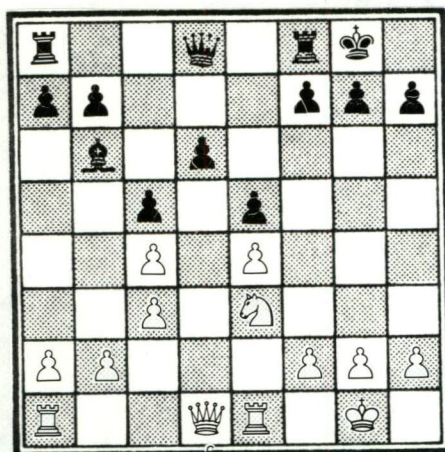
10. Q-Q1
11. P-QB3 B-N3



12. R-K1

This rook move is fairly pointless, as with the pawns blocked at K4 and K5, there is little chance of the king file being opened. It would have been better to play 12 K-R1, to prepare to open the king's bishop file by P-KB4.

12. B-K3
13. N-K3 BXB
14. PXB P-QB4?

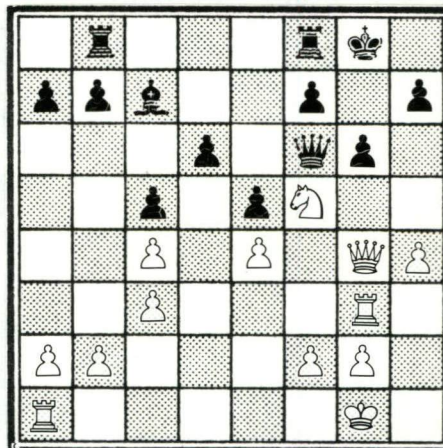


If there was a prize for the world's worst positional move, black's last must be a strong candidate. With one blow (P-QB4) black incarcerates his bishop, gives white a perfect outpost at Q5 for his knight (because the knight can no longer be driven away by a pawn), and leaves his pawn at Q3 weak and backward on an open file.

15. N-B5 B-B2
16. Q-N4 Q-B3
17. R-K3

White puts all his eggs in the basket of a king side attack, whereas pressure along the queen file by doubling rooks would have kept a centralised position and possibilities of attack in favourable circumstances.

17. QR-N1
18. R-N3 P-KN3
19. P-KR4!



White plays very consistently to increase the pressure on black's king position. Unfortunately, he has chosen as a target one of the strongest fortresses known to the chess board - a pawn supported by two of its fellows. Even assuming white plays P-R5 and PXNP, he still will not be able to break down black's defences without a ruinous sacrifice. So, in conclusion, white's attack is doomed to frustration.

19. P-KR4??

Black's nerve cracks and with it his position. Far from driving the white queen away, this move only loses a pawn after 20 QXRP (PXQ is illegal), and later white will be finally able to demolish black's pawn barricade with a later P-R5 and PXNP.

20. Q-B3?

White misses it and gives black the chance to repair the damage with
20 K-R1 20 P-QR3

Hopeful. As white had missed QXRP last move, black thinks he will do so a second time.

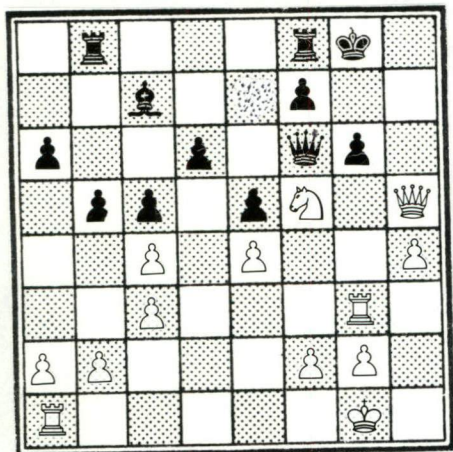
21. QXRP!

He didn't.

21. P-QN4

22. N-R6ch K-N2

23. N-B5ch K-N1



White is not quite sure how to continue here and tries a few knight checks before he finds the most promising course - to move the queen and chip away at the NP with P-KR5

24. Q-N4

This is okay, but better is 24 Q-R6 which incarcerates the black king more firmly. Notice what an ineffective bystander that poor bishop at C5 is.

24. PXP

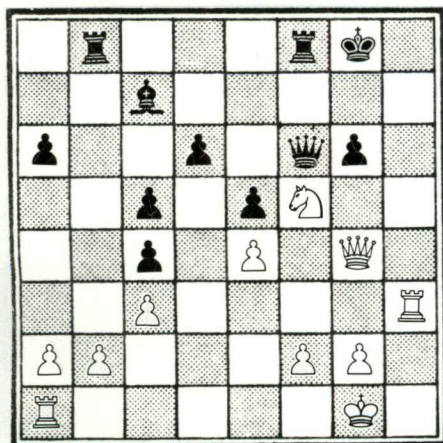
25. P-R5!

The ceiling starts to crumble away above the quivering black figurehead.

25. K-R2

26. PXPch PXP

27. R-R3ch K-N1



Another moment of crisis. The most logical course is to play now 28 R-R6, demolishing the last flimsy outpost on KN6, but instead white dreams up a final 'combination'.

28. N-K7ch? QXN

29. QXNPch

The pawn finally falls, but it has cost white a good knight's sleep.

29. Q-N2!

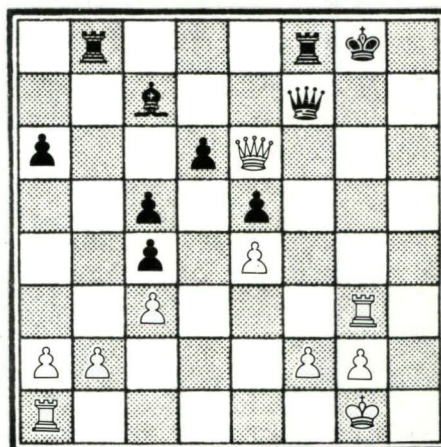
Offering the exchange of queens. White must refuse.

30. Q-K6ch!

Keeps the attack going and prepares to answer 30 ... R-B2 with 31 R-N3 pinning the black queen.

30. Q-B2!

31. R-N3ch



Black must play 31 K-R1 here, when a draw by perpetual check is the probable outcome. Instead his king goes to a fatal square and the game goes with it.

31. K-R2??

32. Q-R3ch

There is no satisfactory interposition so black is mated next move. An exciting display by two of Surrey's most promising under 11's.

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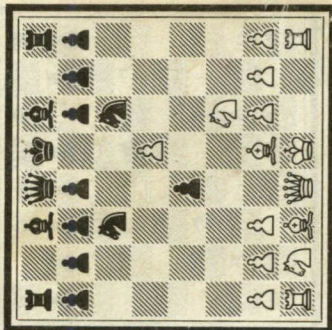
12 Myes

Waiting to be played by John M. Taylor

At the London tournament of 1922, Tartakover, a player of novel opening lines, had white against Bogolyubov: 1 P-K4 P-K4 2 N-KB3 N-QB3 3 B-K2? N-B3 4 P-Q3 etc. This line may be found in *Modern Chess Openings* as the Inverted Hanham.

In December 1979, with my pocket set handy, I was following this game and wondered what would happen if White played 4 P-Q4 instead.

My preliminary analysis suggested that Black's only sound reply (apart possibly from 4 ... P-Q3) is 4 ... PXP, to which White replies 5 P-K5.



Now Black must play 5 ... N-Q4, 5 ... N-K5 or 5 ... N-K5. In all cases, White seemed to get good play, and the surprise value over the board would be considerable. I was therefore gratified to have three opportunities to play it. Hebdien tried, most interesting theoretically: 5 ... N-K5 6 NXP P-Q4? 7 O-O NxN 8 QxN B-QB4 9 Q-Q3 O-O 10 N-B3 B-B4 11 NxP R-K1 12 B-B4 B-KN3 13 QR-Q1? NxP etc.

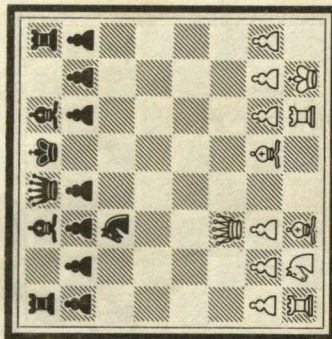
White should have played 13 Q-QN3 with winning prospects. Even so, I got counterplay for my loss of the exchange, and only lost through later blunders. My subsequent analysis showed that 6 ... B-B4 is very strong, and that White could avoid this trouble by 6 O-O, when the best line appeared to be 6 ... P-Q4 7 NxP transposing to the game. My subsequent more complete analysis confirmed confidence in the system 3 B-K2 and 4 P-Q4, so I wrote this out and showed it to Peter Sanderson who

has been good enough to act as "Devil's Advocate". He showed interest but was somewhat sceptical of the strength of the opening. Later, we came to some sort of consensus. I exclude lines of Philidor character where Black holds the centre with ... P-Q3. If this is best for Black, then White has a space advantage, and the line would have an important impact on opening theory.

First four inferior lines for Black:

- 1 P-K4 P-K4 2 N-KB3 N-QB3 3 B-K2 B-B4 4 NxP Q-R5? 5 N-Q3; 5 ... N-B3 4 P-Q4 P-Q4? 5 QPxP KxNP 6 O-O B-K2 7 P-B4 QxP 8 Q-B2 B-KB4 9 R-Q1;
- 4 ... NxKP 5 P-Q5 QN moves 6 Q-K2 pointless;
- 4 ... PXP 5 P-K5 N-Q4 6 O-O followed by 7 P-B3. 6 NxP was played in Taylor v Lenton: 6 ... NxP 7 O-O P-Q3 8 R-K1 B-K2 9 B-QN5ch K-B1; is also quite good for White.

- 5 ... N-KN5 6 O-O and now:
 - 6 ... N(N5)xKP 7 NxN NxN 8 QxP N-B3 9 Q-B3.



White appears to have more than enough for the pawn, e.g. 9 ... Q-B3 (9 ... P-Q4 10 B-QN5 followed by R-K1ch is worse) 10 QxQ PxQ 11 N-B3, when Black has inferior development, weak pawns and a rather exposed king.

- 6 ... P-Q3 7 NxP N(N5)xKP 8 P-KB4 N-N3 9 NxN PxN 10 Q-Q4 when Black has no satisfactory continuation.
- 6 ... B-K2 7 NxP N(N5)xKP 8 P-KB4 is good for White.
- 6 ... B-B4 7 B-KN5 B-K2

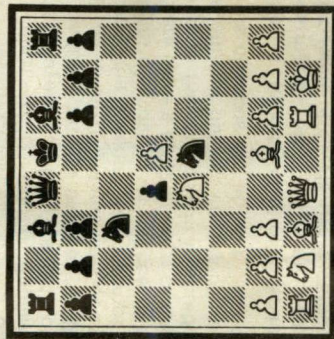
(7 ... P-B3 8 PxP and now both 8 ... NxP(B3) 9 P-B3! and 8 ... PxP 9 B-R4 O-O 10 P-B3! are good for White) 8 BxB QxB 9 NxP N(N5)xKP 10 N-N5 followed by N(N1)-B3 or P-KB4 is good for White.

B 5 ... N-K5 6 O-O (best). Now the two likely bishop moves look weak:

- 6 ... B-B4 7 B-Q3 P-B4 8 BxN PxN 9 N-N5 NxP 10 NxKP Q-K2 11 B-N5 Q-B1 12 P-KB4 White wins.

- 6 ... B-K2 7 NxP NxKP? 8 N-B5 B-B3 9 Q-Q5 N-Q3 10 NxNch PxN 11 QxQP, good for White.

Thus 6 ... P-Q4 7 NxP looks best.

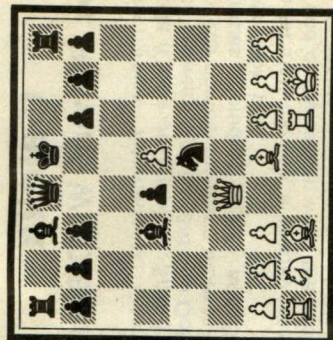


White plans 8 NxN, 9 B-K3, 10 P-KB3 etc. Now 7 ... B-QB4 allows 8 NxN PxN 9 N-Q2 NxN 10 QxN! with threats of 11 Q-B3, 11 P-QN4, or 11 Q-N5, so Black has:

- 7 ... NxKP 8 P-KB3 N-KB3 (8 ... N-Q3 9 P-KB4 with very strong pressure, e.g. 9 ... N-N3 10 P-B5 or 9 ... N-B3 10 N-QB3) 9 B-QN5ch P-B3 10 R-K1 PxP (10 ... B-Q3 11 P-KB4) 11 RxNch B-K2 12 Q-K2.

7 ... NxN 8 QxN B-QB4 9 Q-Q3. White's queen looks oddly placed but she retains flexibility with control of the third rank. Black cannot effectively attack the KP. **DIAGRAM**

- 9 ... O-O 10 N-B3. As in Taylor v Hebdien; Black's best now appears to be 10 ... NxN but 11 QxN leaves White the initiative. Only further practical tests can decide whether Black can slowly equalise or whether White can use his KP as a basis for a win by king's side pressure. However, White can also try 10 N-Q2 or 10 B-K3 meeting 10 ... P-Q5 by 11 QxN PxN 12 P-KB4! stranding Black's KP.



ii) 9 ... B-B4. Now 10 Q-N5ch looks too risky, e.g. 10 ... P-QB3 11 QxNP O-O 12 QxQBP Q-R5 13 B-K3 P-Q5 14 P-KN3 Q-R6 etc. Also 10 N-B3 P-QB3! seems to give Black at least equal chances. However, it seems there is 10 B-K3! and now:

- 10 ... N-N6 11 Q-N5ch P-QB3 12 QxB NxPch 13 K-R1, when Black's knight looks doomed.

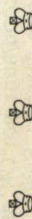
- 10 ... BxB 11 QxB O-O 12 P-KN4 followed by P-KB3 and P-KB4 highlights the dangers inherent in 9 ... B-B4.

- 10 ... B-QN3 11 Q-R3! BxB 12 QxB transposes to b), or 11 ... Q-K2 12 BxB QxQ 13 NxQ RxB 14 N-N5 with strong play for White.

- 10 ... Q-Q2 11 BxB NxN 12 Q-QR3! causes problems.

- 10 ... P-Q5 11 B-B4 O-O 12 Q-KB3! (threat: 13 B-Q3) 12 ... P-KB3 (12 ... P-KN4? 13 B-Q3) 13 B-B4ch K-R1 14 P-K6 followed by R-K1, N-Q2, or BxP.

I would be interested in readers' constructive comments. The moves are all there, only waiting to be played!



The **Greater London Council** plan a repeat in 1982 of the prestigious **Phillips and Drew** international tournament last April, allocating £1000 from lottery funds.

Mrs. Nancy Elder, Dundee, Scottish Lady Champion has died on holiday in Australia.

She had won the title 14 times before — the last in 1974. She was awarded the OBE for her services to the game in Scotland.